Journal
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Adelaide/Brisbane Australia
29 August 2010 – 11 September 2010

Preface:

Travel to Australia was organized for a Keynote presentation at the IMPC2010 in Brisbane and to visit the Wark Institute, University of South Australia in Adelaide at the invitation of the Director, friend, and colleague, Professor John Ralston. My first trip to Australia was in 1983 to participate in, and present a paper at, the Sir Ian Wark Symposium in July 1983. Sir Ian was still alive at that time and I had the distinct pleasure to meet him at the symposium being held in his honor. The Wark Institute was created subsequently by John Ralston and it seems appropriate to visit the Wark Institute now some 27 years since I met Sir Ian. Trips to Australia have included,

1983 Wark Symposium, Adelaide
1986 Applications of Surface Science, Royal Australian Institute for Chemistry, Perth
1987 South Australian Institute of Technology, Adelaide, August 1987
1987 Western Australian School of Mines, Kalgoorlie, September 1987
1988 7th Australian Electrochemical Conference, University NSW, Kensington, February 1988
1991 World Gold 91, Cairns, April 1991
1993 IMPC, Sydney, May 1993
2004 Separation Technology, Engineering Foundation, Fraser Island, October 2004
2005 Centenary of Flotation Conference, Brisbane, June 2005
2010 IMPC, Brisbane, September 2010

Memorable events included America's Cup competition and travel to the gold fields of the Kalgoorlie area when I was in Perth, travel by van from Adelaide through Melbourne to Sydney with John Ralston and students for the Electrochemistry Conference during which time we visited the Seven Sisters rock formation on the coast, a visit to the Great Barrier Reef when at Cairns in 1991, and the trip with Patricia to Fraser Island and on to the University of Newcastle in 2004.



Professor John Ralston, Director, Wark Institute,
University of South Australia, IMPC, Brisbane,
September 2010

The current trip to Australia included first a visit with Professor John Ralston at the Wark Institute, University of South Australia, Tuesday 31 August 2010 - Saturday 4 September 2010. Then travel to Brisbane for the International Mineral Processing Congress, IMPC2010, returning to Salt Lake City on 11 September 2010, in time to see the Utes football game with UNLV.

Sunday - Tuesday (29 - 31 August 2010)

After packing, including my new cell phone organized for international telephone calls, Patricia took me to the SLC airport to catch a United flight for LA at 8:30 pm. All went well although the congestion at LAX was terrible. I was a bit concerned that I might miss my Qantas flight to Brisbane. Nevertheless, the Lord provided, my carry-on luggage was accepted without the problems last had on this flight with Patricia in 2005, and departure was accomplished without difficulty. I even had a vacant seat beside me for the 14 hour flight to Brisbane. On arrival Customs was cleared and I took ground transport to the domestic terminal for my flight to Adelaide. This segment of travel also was without difficulty, my carry-on luggage was accommodated, my driver was waiting, and I was delivered at almost noon on Tuesday 31 August to the Oaks Horizon Hotel, all of which had been arranged by Professor Ralston. Fortunately the hotel has a lap pool and, even though exhausted, I had a nice swim that afternoon. Of course my international cell phone did not function so I contacted Patricia by email. A day later she had solved the problem. It should be mentioned that during the flight which included crossing the International Date Line, Granny's birthday, 30 August 2010, was missed. Consequently celebration on the plane was rather subdued. In any case, happy birthday wishes for Patricia.

Wednesday 1 September 2010

After a morning swim, Professor Ralston sent a driver for me to take me to the Wark Institute. Most of the day was spent visiting with researchers and touring laboratories. John has been quite successful with his research programs and I was impressed. One meeting with David Beattie on the surface spectroscopy of adsorbed polymers, including dextrin, was particularly interesting, as was a brief meeting with Daniel Forniesaro on liberation. The evening concluded with dinner at the Ralston's. John and Ann are excited about the marriage of son Matt to Natasha in October of this year. I'm still waiting to have a good sleep and hopefully my jet lag will subside in a few more days.

Thursday 2 September 2010

After a morning swim a visit to the Wark Institute was scheduled. The drive from the Oaks Horizon Hotel is about 20 minutes. My driver came at about 9am. The weather has been cool, cloudy with rain, not to be expected in Adelaide. In the morning I met with Dayang Wang and Thomas Mann to discuss nano particles and then Marta Krasowska regarding her research on bubble attachment and collectorless flotation. She has found that ~1 micron titantia will float below the PZC of pH 4 where the particles are positively charged and the bubbles are negatively charged. Marta was a student at the Surface Science Institute in Krakow where she studied with our friends Andrzej Pomianowski and Kazimierz Malysa. We had lunch with Bill Skinner, Jonas, Marta, and Sarah Harmer. Bill and Sarah are planning to acquire both a micro CT and a nano CT from Xradia. After lunch I met with an old friend Keith Quast. I first met Keith in 1976 when he visited Utah. Both of his children, a son and a daughter, studied metallurgical engineering and graduated from the University of South Australia with degrees. Keith showed me the new pilot plant facilities at the Wark. I called David Smith, son-in-law, to wish him a happy birthday. It was still 1 September in the US and Dave was surprised to hear from me just before Prayer Meeting began at Grace Baptist Church in West Columbia, South Carolina. The day concluded with Bill Skinner taking me to dinner with Lee White, a well known colloid chemist and mathematician who had returned to the University of South Australia in Adelaide after spending 10 years at Carnegie

Mellon University in the US. We visited with Lee at his home and then went for dinner at the Corner Bistro in the city before returning to the Oaks.

Friday 3 September 2010

Friday I had lunch at the Pub with George Levay and Leslie. I had Kangaroo steak. In the afternoon George and Leslie took me for shopping and I acquired some opal. In the evening I had dinner at the Assaggio Ristorante with John, Ann, and Swedish visitors; I had lamb chops which were excellent.

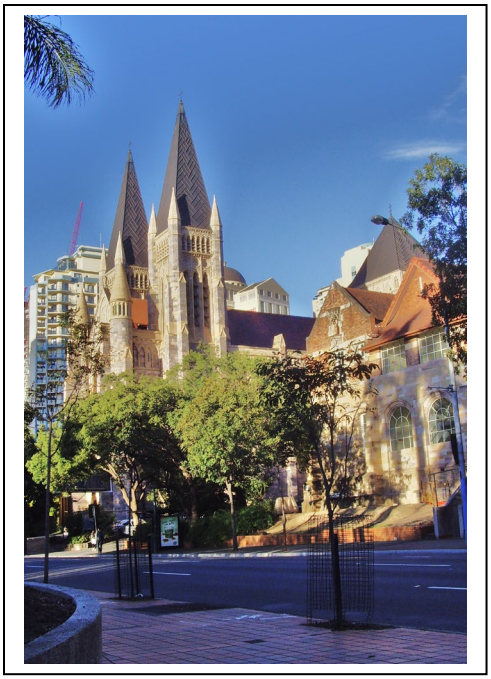
Also, the opal mines of South Australia are around the Cooper Pedy area in the outback half way between Adelaide and Alice Springs. The next visit to Adelaide must include a trip to Cooper Pedy.

Saturday 4 September 2010

Lots of rain again in Adelaide. Today was a free day. After swimming in the morning, I wrote emails to my researchers. Lunch was at the Aroma Cafe adjacent to the Oaks Horizon Hotel. At 1:30 pm the Hughes limousine driver came for me to take me to the airport. We met John and Ann Ralston and others from the Wark Institute at the new Adelaide Airport. Also, Laurindo from the University of Sao Paulo, Brazil, was there with his Post Doctoral Fellow, Marisa. Everyone was going to Brisbane. We arrived in Brisbane at 6:10 pm and were greeted by Dee Bradshaw. I went with Michael and Dee to their home for a dinner of lasagna, vegetables, salad, potatoes, and ice cream. They have a nice apartment on the river and within walking distance of the JKMRC where Dee works. They are doing well as grandparents and expect to see their grandson, Jack, in November when everyone will be in Cape Town for a marriage. Michael and Dee took me to my hotel, The Ridges South Bank, at about 9 pm where I checked-in. There were great fireworks on the Brisbane River for some celebration. No swimming pool. The Bradshaw's send their love to Patricia and the family.

Sunday 5 September 2010

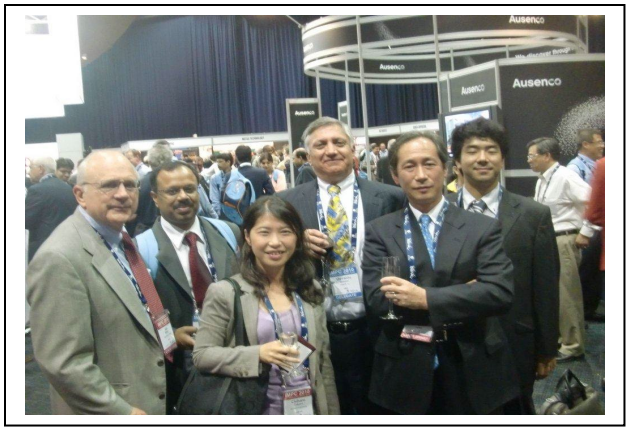
Rain in Brisbane today. Jin Liu, former postdoctoral fellow with us at the Univesity of Utah, came today with nuts, candy, and fruit and to show me around Brisbane. She is spending 3 months with Professor Anh Nguyen at the University of Queensland. We traveled the Brisbane River on the CitiCAT and then visited the botanical gardens. The bougainville was in bloom. It was wet. Plenty of birds there, including pelicans. After lunch, barramundi, we returned to the Rydges/Convention Center and met many Chinese friends from Changsha, including Tao Jiang and Dr.Qui (pronounced Chew), former VP at Central South University, who presented us the Honorary Professor Award in 2007. Registration was then completed and we now prepare for the conference beginning tomorrow morning. I have a session in the afternoon tomorrow and then present the Keynote talk on Wednesday afternoon.



Brisbane City Church,
September 2010

Monday 6 September 2010

The IMPC sessions began today. I was responsible for one session in the afternoon. All went well. Jin Liu continues to take good care of me, bringing fruits and nuts. Just now she is charging my cell phone and will bring it to me on Tuesday or Wednesday. Lots of invitations to travel to Brazil (University of Sao Paulo, Laurindo), Chile (Concepcion, Sergio Castro), Canada (University of Alberta-Xhenghe Xu), China (Changsha-Tao Jiang, Yuehua Hu and Shanxi-Fangqin Cheng). Many friends were met at the reception last night. I had a nice conversation with Barbara and Janusz Laskowski. We had a good time recalling Patricia's shopping trip with Barbara and Nanette O'Connor in Istanbul. Barbara wanted to know if the semaver was used or just for decoration. Barbara has found some therapy for her back pain and recommends the regimen described in "Pain Free" by Pete Egoscue, available from Amazon.



JDM with Amlan Datta, Oswaldo Bascur, and Japanese researchers, IMPC, Brisbane, September 2010

Tuesday 7 September 2010

Not too much of interest today other than selected papers presented at the IMPC. The weather has been great today, as it was on Monday. Fangqin arrived from Shanxi and we will meet tomorrow with Qinbo. My former postdoc, Jin Liu, now for 3 months with Anh at the University of Queensland, charged my cell phone and I was able to call Patricia. In the evening Rob Dunne of Newmont took us to dinner at the ERA Bistro close by the Convention Center (Ronel Kappes, Cyril O'Connor, John and Ann Ralston, Brent Hiskey). My keynote presentation is scheduled for tomorrow afternoon.

Wednesday 8 September 2010

IMPC sessions were attended as scheduled. I met with Qinbo and Fangqin Cheng of Shanxi University to discuss Qinbo's thesis. Fangqin Cheng, who is a Christian, is Director of a Research Institute at Shanxi. This is the university that Xuming has been working with. It is not clear what Qinbo's specific objectives are for his thesis. Fangqin Cheng brought gifts as usual. Also I met with Professor Yuehua Hu. He is excited about the possibility to be appointed President at Central South University in Changsha.

In the afternoon, I had my keynote lecture which was well received. The banquet was held this evening in the Plaza Ballroom. Entertainment was provided by "The Three Waiters." These guys pretended they were part of the hotel staff. Really, they were professional opera singers. One was to be an Italian, one a Frenchman, and one a Spaniard. In any case they did a great job both with the singing and with the comedy. At the banquet, Life-Time-Achievement awards were given to Wang Dianzou, former President at Central South University (we met him at the Chinese Academy of Sciences, Beijing 2007) and Alban Lynch who founded JKMRC (he was a guest professor with Rex Bull at CSM in 1967).



Lifetime Achievement Award presentation: L to R – Robin Batterham (IMPC 2010 President), Cyril O'Connor (IMPC Chairman), Prof. Wang Dianzuo, Prof. Alban Lynch, and Eric Forssberg (past IMPC Chairman), Brisbane, September 2010

Thursday 9 September 2010

I was excused from the IMPC sessions today and Jin Liu, former postdoctoral fellow with us at Utah and a good friend of Xuming Wang, took me to the Noosa Heads about 3 hours north of Brisbane. It was an interesting day traveling by bus and train. We took the bus to Central Station and then the train from Brisbane to Nambour. From Nambour we went by bus to Noosa Heads on the coast. There is a beautiful beach at Noosa and I enjoyed a good swim in the ocean. After that we went to Noosa National Park and had a tour of a tropical forest. Interesting wild birds included the Australian Brush Turkey and the Eastern Whip bird. I know Lew would have enjoyed the Whip bird which makes a very unique sound. In this region of Queensland they produce a major amount of ginger. Tours are available. We then returned to Brisbane in time to visit the Gold Coast with other delegates at the IMPC.

In the evening the IMPC delegates traveled to the Gold Coast (~1 hour south of Brisbane) where we were treated to the Australian Outback Spectacular. This dinner show featured superb horsemen/women who entertained us with the history/traditions of the Australian Outback, particularly the importance of their horses. We had a good meal and an enjoyable show with very skilled riders and horses. We then returned to our hotel, the Rydges Southbank in Brisbane.

Friday 10 September 2010

The IMPC has basically concluded with a Workshop on Sustainability. Today, it began raining in Brisbane as I traveled the Brisbane River to the University of Queensland (UQ) on the CitiCAT with Jin Liu. We had a fine time touring the campus, the laboratories, and meeting with Professor Anh Nguyen's students and researchers. The lake on campus is home to many and varied birds, fish/eels, turtles, large lizards, and other creatures that we did not see, I suppose. Pizza was served for the lunch we shared with the students. Also, visiting today were Rob Dunne,

Newmont, and Qinbo/Fangqin Cheng from Shanxi. In the afternoon with Rob Dunne, we visited the JKMRC and Dee Bradshaw. The JKMRC is not far from the UQ campus. Rob had arranged a taxi for us.



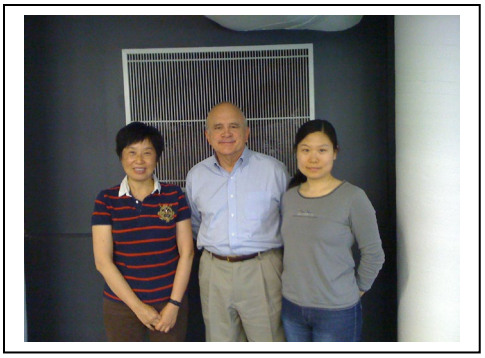
University of Queensland,
Brisbane, September 2010



Australian White Ibis at
University of Queensland
Lake, Brisbane, September
2010



JDM at UQ, the CitiCAT,
Brisbane, September 2010



Jin Liu, JDM, and Orhan
Ozdemir's friend at UQ,
Brisbane, September 2010

Later in the afternoon we returned to the UQ campus for further research discussion including future visits of researchers from our group at the U of U to UQ in order to maintain our many years of collaboration with Anh Nguyen. Past researchers from our group who have visited at UQ have included Vamsi Parachuri, Hao Du, Shoeleh Assemi, Orhan Ozdemir, and Vishal Gupta. The day concluded with dinner at the home of Anh Nguyen with wife, Linn, and children, Annie, Bindy, and David. Linn had prepared a wonderful dinner and we had a great time. However, David would not play the piano claiming that he is a scientist now. Anh returned me to the hotel in the city at about 10 pm.



Dr. Anh Nguyen and JDM enjoying a moment
together at the IMPC 2010, Brisbane,
September 2010



Professor Anh Nguyen and Family,
Brisbane, 2010